

keyboard. It's easier but initial configuring of the system will have to be done. The newly released AMD 785 chipset is also great for this kind of work and also some light gaming. If you don't want the HTPC board, and something really cheap, the Jetway PN78VM2-LF makes good sense.

Almost all of the AMD chipsets have graphics integrated into them. The AMD 790FX chipset is one such. It's similar to 790GX, but without the on-board graphics. MSI's 790FX-GD70 and Gigabyte's MA790FXT-UD5P are two such models. The MSI model sells at Rs. 9,700 and the Gigabyte at around Rs. 12,000.

Selecting motherboards isn't the simplest thing to do. There are a few things to remember though. The performance of motherboards doesn't deviate a lot so you don't really have to worry - a maximum of between 2 to 5 per cent is noticed across all benchmarks of a board using a single chipset. In general, look for motherboards with PCI and PCIe slots with sufficient space between them. This is just precautionary measure so you can plug in a dedicated graphics card and maybe even an additional sound card. Micro ATX boards will usually have less space to do this.

Make sure the board uses solid state capacitors. Stability and reliability goes up. Also make sure that capacitors are placed out of the way of graphics cards and all the SATA ports. The SATA ports should also be positioned such that the cables from the SATA boards don't run into the graphics cards. CrossFire and SLI support is also a welcomed feature. This



MSI P55-GD 65

means you can add two identical graphics cards and use their combined performance. The cooling solutions used on the boards should also be looked at. Large heat sinks interlinked with copper heat pipes is just part of the norm several manufacturers follow. The cheaper the board, the lesser of it you'll notice.

